

FULL PRIVACY STACK GUIDE

DESKTOP + MOBILE • ALL THREE OPTIONS • DETAILED STEPS

OPTION A — EASIEST: BRAVE + VPN

DESKTOP:

1. Install Brave Browser.
2. Open Settings → Shields.
3. Set:
 - Block trackers & ads: ON
 - Upgrade connections to HTTPS: ON
 - Block fingerprinting: Aggressive
 - Block third-party cookies: ON
4. Use VPN (Nord, etc.) normally.
5. Turn OFF Threat Protection inside VPN (to avoid DNS hijacking).

MOBILE (iOS & Android):

1. Install Brave.
2. Go to Settings → Brave Shields & Privacy.
3. Turn on:
 - Block trackers & ads
 - HTTPS upgrades
 - Fingerprinting protection
4. Use VPN normally.

OPTION B — STRONG PRIVACY: FIREFOX + NEXTDNS DOH

DESKTOP (Windows/Mac):

1. Install Firefox.
2. Open Firefox Menu (≡) → Settings → Privacy & Security.
3. Set Enhanced Tracking Protection → STRICT.
4. Scroll down:
 - Enable “Delete cookies and site data when Firefox is closed.”
5. Enable HTTPS-Only Mode:
 - Scroll to HTTPS-Only Mode → Enable for all windows.
6. Enable Resist Fingerprinting:
 - In address bar type: about:config
 - Accept warning
 - Search: privacy.resistFingerprinting
 - Set to TRUE
7. Enable DNS-over-HTTPS (DoH):
 - Settings → General → scroll to Network Settings → Settings...
 - Check “Enable DNS over HTTPS”
 - Provider: CUSTOM
 - URL:
`https://dns.nextdns.io/YOUR-CONFIG-ID`
 - Click OK.

MOBILE (iOS/Android):

1. Install Firefox mobile.
2. Open Firefox → Menu → Settings → Tracking Protection → STRICT.
3. Turn ON HTTPS-Only Mode:
 - Settings → Privacy → HTTPS-Only → ON.
4. Enable DoH:
 - Settings → Network → Secure DNS
 - Choose “Custom”

- Enter:

<https://dns.nextdns.io/YOUR-CONFIG-ID>

OPTION C — MAX PRIVACY:

NEXTDNS APP + VPN + HARDENED FIREFOX

DESKTOP:

1. Install NextDNS APP from nextdns.io/apps.
2. Log in → Choose your profile.
3. Enable:
 - Encrypted DNS
 - System-wide protection
4. Install Firefox.
5. Apply all Firefox hardening steps listed in Option B.
6. Open VPN:
 - Turn OFF Threat Protection
 - Use any server

MOBILE (iOS):

1. Install NextDNS app.
2. Log in → Enable protection.
3. iOS will ask to install a configuration profile → ALLOW.
4. Open Firefox mobile and apply STRICT tracking protection + HTTPS-Only Mode.

MOBILE (Android):

1. Install NextDNS app.
2. Log in → Enable system DNS.
3. OR set Android Private DNS:
 - Settings → Network & Internet → Private DNS

- Choose Private DNS provider hostname:

dns.nextdns.io

4. Install Firefox → enable STRICT tracking protection + HTTPS-Only Mode.

VERIFICATION FOR ALL OPTIONS

1. Visit:

<https://test.nextdns.io>

Should show:

- Status: OK
- Resolver: NextDNS
- Your profile name

2. Visit:

<https://dnsleaktest.com>

Should show:

- Your VPN server IP (if VPN is on)
- DNS = NextDNS

YOU ARE NOW PROTECTED AGAINST:

- Data broker tracking
- Hidden third-party cookies
- Behavioral profiling
- Script-based tracking
- Fingerprinting
- ISP DNS logging
- VPN DNS override

- Unencrypted DNS leaks
- Website cross-site tracking
- Ad-tech analytics